

Programming for Economist

PS 3

Class 3

Matias B.F. Hall,
Institute of Economics,
September 2026

KØBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET



Plan for today

1. Functions and Classes
2. Work on PS3

If you want I can go through some of the questions on the board. Just let me know:)

1. Functions

We define a function by:

```
def FunctionName(arguments*, keywords arguments* = ..):  
    stuff..  
    return Outputs*
```

Call the function by:

```
Outputnames* = FunctionName(InputName*, ..)
```

1. Classes

- Classes are blueprints for creating **objects**
- They contain data accessed as **attributes** and class specific functions called **methods**.
- You can create multiple **instances** of a class with their own set of attributes and methods.
- Today you will create your own simple class and use it to create multiple objects.

1. Classes

We Define a Class by:

```
class ClassName(InheritedClasses*):
```

Initialise the class with:

```
def __init__(self, attributes*):
```

- 'self' represents the instance of the class
- Set attributes by `self.AttributeName = attribute`
- To inherit all attributes and methods from parent class use:

```
super().__init__(ParentClassAttributes*)
```

- Define one or more methods with:

```
def MethodName(self, args*):
```

- Create an instance of the class with

```
ObjectName = ClassName(attributes*):
```

- Access attributes and methods of the specific class instance

```
ObjectName.AttributeName
```

```
ObjectName.MethodName(args*)
```